

"Alia is what I call a raw star. She knows what will work and what won't. She doesn't think much, just comes to the set, acts, and is brilliant"

**MOHIT SURI**
*Filmmaker/ Cousin*

# A BORN STAR

## ALIA BHATT, 28

*Actor*

In the decade she has spent facing the camera, Alia Bhatt has time and again shown why she is touted as one of the best young actresses in show business. Whether shouldering an entire film as in *Highway* (2014), only her second film, and *Raazi* (2018) or shining in an ensemble as in *Kapoor & Sons*, *Udta Punjab* (both 2016) and *Gully Boy* (2019), Alia is up to task. Behind the apparent effortlessness is a discerning mind, consciously pushing her out of her comfort zone. That audiences reward her effort by watching her films in theatres has only increased her stature as one of the few actresses with box office clout. So commanding is her screen presence that even in a mediocre outing you can't help but notice her.

Her upcoming line-up betrays the young Bhatt's ambition—to collaborate with popular filmmakers on big-budget spectacles (*RRR*, *Brahmastra*, *Rocky aur Rani Ki Prem Kahani*) as well as satiating the artist in her (*Gangubai Kathiawadi* and her maiden film as producer, *Darlings*). By signing on with the William Morris Agency, a premier talent management agency in Hollywood, Alia is clearly eyeing a successful career not just at home but abroad too. ■

**– Suhani Singh**

**INSPIRED NOMENCLATURE** **Alia named her production house after one of her favourite films, *Eternal Sunshine of the Spotless Mind*, featuring Jim Carrey and Kate Winslet.**